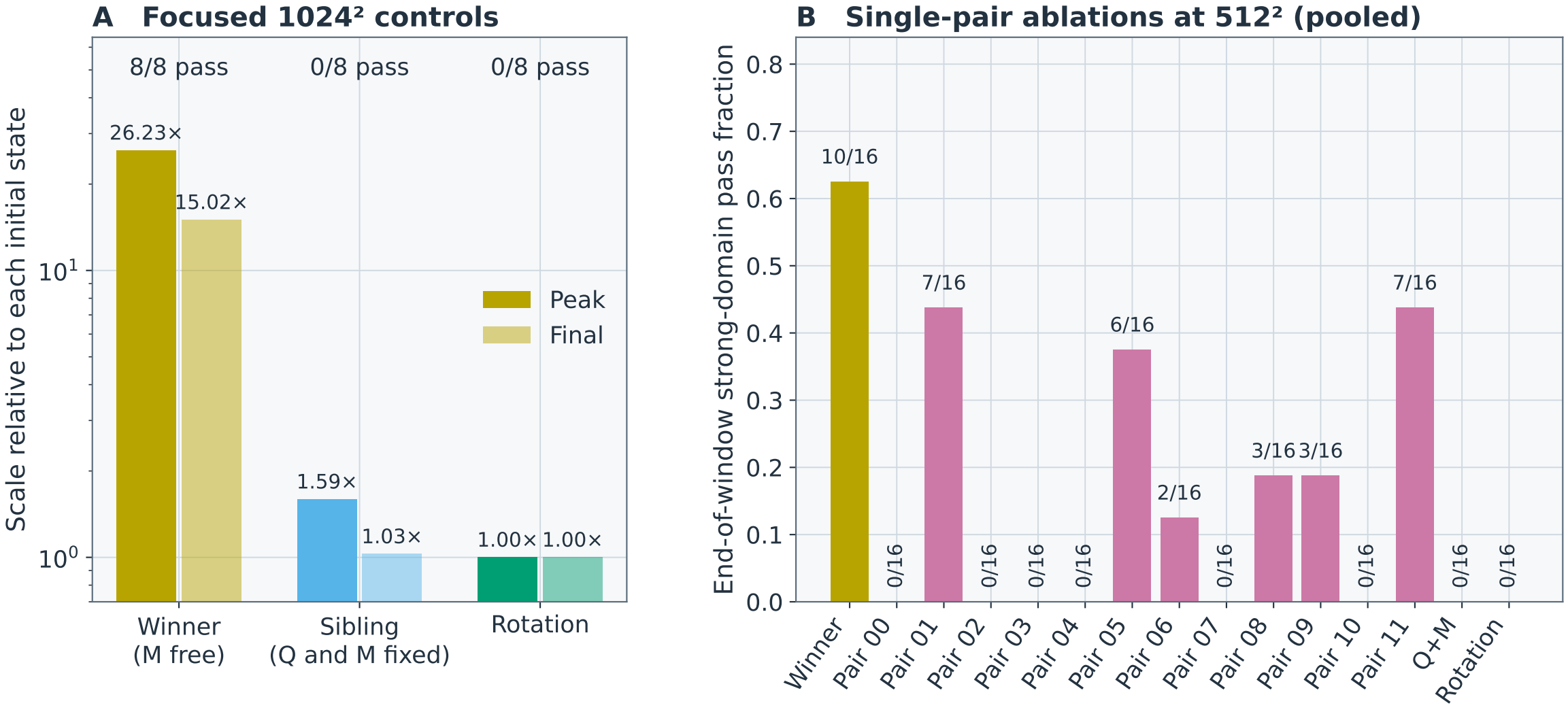Matched controls constrain the mechanism in the tested rule family